Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held Electronically on Monday, January 24, 2022

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Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		A. Khan
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 7:06 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the minutes of the Regular Meeting of Council held on December 13, 2021 be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Question Period

Mayor Collier noted that members of the public were advised they could submit questions regarding the agenda to the Town Clerk up until noon on the day of the meeting. Alexander Harras, Manager of Legislative Services/Deputy Clerk, noted that one item of correspondence had been received in relation to By-law 03-2022 and circulated to Council Members in advance of the meeting.

5. Delegations and Presentations

5.1 Presentation: Collection of Recyclables at Canada Post Super Mailboxes

Dave Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, delivered a presentation on the collection of recyclables at Canada Post super mailboxes. D. Meredith reviewed the notice of motion, municipal comparators, inventory and locations of Canada Post mailboxes in Ajax, pilot project details, costs associated with the pilot program, and the future of recyclables in Ontario.

Council Members asked questions regarding duration of the pilot project, opportunities to implement a signage program, public education campaign initiatives, methods to mitigate dumping, waste issues among area municipalities, opportunities to implement consistent communication strategies throughout the Region, impacts to current service levels, funding sources, opportunities to have the Region of Durham pilot the pickup of recyclables, and the number of active pilot projects in the Region. D. Meredith responded to questions from Council Members.

Mayor Collier vacated the Chair. Regional Councillor Crawford assumed the Chair.

Motion to Refer

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: S. Collier

That the Super Community Mailbox Recyclables Collection pilot program be referred to the February 14, 2022 GGC Operating Budget meeting for consideration during the 2022 Operating Budget deliberations.

CARRIED

Regional Councillor Crawford vacated the Chair. Mayor Collier assumed the Chair.

6. Correspondence

Members separated correspondence items 6.1, 6.2, 6.3, 6.8, 6.9 and 6.10 for discussion.

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the balance of the report (Items 6.4, 6.5, 6.6, 6.7, 6.11 and 6.12) dated January 24, 2022 containing Items of Correspondence be received for information.

CARRIED

Items 6.1 and 6.9

Council Members discussed the motions, noting their opposition to Quebec's Bill 21.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Item 6.1 (Region of Durham – Discrimination of Freedom of Religion in Quebec's Bill 21) and Item 6.9 (Town of Bradford West Gwillimbury – Motion against Quebec's Bill 21) of the Correspondence Report be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item 6.2

Council Members discussed the correspondence and Vision Zero enforcement activities.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: S. Lee

That Item 6.2 (Region of Durham – Vision Zero – Increased Enforcement) of the Correspondence Report be received for information.

CARRIED

Item 6.3

Council Members discussed the correspondence, acknowledging the homelessness crisis.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: L. Bower

That Item 6.3 (Region of Durham – Homelessness Task Force) of the Correspondence Report be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item 6.8

Council Members asked if the Town of Ajax has administrative fees related to name changes and revision of official documents. Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative & Information Services/Clerk, responded to the question from Council Members.

Motion to Refer

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: J. Dies

That Item 6.8 (Township of Mulmur – Truth and Reconciliation Calls to Action – in particular, the clause related to the waiving of fees for name changes) of the Correspondence Report be referred to Town staff for consideration.

CARRIED

Item 6.10

Council Members discussed the motion, noting their support for the Jewish community and a scheduled delegation and proclamation request to be received in May.

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: S. Lee

That Item 6.10 (B'Nai Brith National Organization of Canada – Jewish Heritage Month) of the Correspondence Report be received for information.

CARRIED

7. Reports

7.1. Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report

None

7.2. General Government Committee Report

7.2.1 General Government Committee, January 10, 2022

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the General Government Committee Report dated January 10, 2022, be adopted.

CARRIED

7.3 Summary of Advisory Committee Activities

None

7.4 Departmental Reports

7.4.1 OES-2022-02: Region of Durham's Proposed Study of the Current Policy/Practice for Streetlighting on Regional Roads

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: J. Dies

1. That Council endorse the draft Terms of Reference and approach for the Region of Durham's Proposed Study of the Current Policy/Practice for Streetlighting on Regional Roads.

2. That the Region's current practice with respect to streetlighting on Regional roads, as described in the Region's Works Committee Report #2021-W-36 (refer to Attachment 1), continue to prevail until the Region's proposed study is completed and any changes are approved and implemented.

3. That staff report OES-2022-02 be forwarded to the Region of Durham.

CARRIED

8. Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Councillor Crawford discussed Vision Zero and noted that Durham Region West Division is pleased to welcome Police Constable David Rickard to the traffic division.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of January 24, 2022 be received for information.

CARRIED

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

Mayor Collier vacated the Chair. Regional Councillor Crawford assumed the Chair.

9.1 Affordable/Discounted Digital Works for Libraries

Regional Councillor Lee and Mayor Collier introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: S. Collier

WHEREAS the Town of Ajax recognizes the important role that libraries play in our community, and the literacy programs they provide are integral to developing proficient readers;

WHEREAS the Town of Ajax recognizes that digital literacy programs run by libraries help ensure citizens can contribute to our digital world;

WHEREAS vulnerable demographic groups, including seniors, low income families, youth, and new Canadians rely on access to libraries as an important tool for their participation in the community;

AND WHEREAS purchasing models of eContent for public libraries are restrictive in comparison to physical item purchasing, prices for eContent are exponentially higher than physical materials, but lending models do not provide additional benefits in line with premium prices;

AND WHEREAS libraries must be in a position to offer eContent to their users as part of their service offering to their community, particularly given the rapid pace of digitization of educational and cultural materials;

AND WHEREAS Ajax Public Library is committed to providing barrier-free access to learning and leisure materials to Ajax residents through means that meet their changing needs;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. Ajax Council supports Canadian libraries in their efforts to increase access to eContent for users;

2. Ajax Council calls on the provincial and federal governments to investigate the barriers faced by libraries in acquiring eContent, and develop a solution that increases access and fair pricing for eContent; and

3. This motion be sent to the appropriate provincial and federal ministers, and all Durham Region Library Boards.

CARRIED

Regional Councillor Crawford vacated the Chair. Mayor Collier assumed the Chair.

10. By-laws

Motion to Suspend the Rules of Procedure

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the Rules of Procedure be suspended in order to introduce By-law number 05-2022, being a by-law to amend the Town's Zoning By-law in relation to application Z5/18 submitted by Fieldgate (Bayly / Salem Developments Ltd).

CARRIED
on 2/3rds

Members of Council asked questions regarding By-law 03-2022 regarding firefighter hiring practices, rationale for timing of fee implementation, similar fees among area municipalities, firefighter recruitment process and costs, testing requirements, projected number of applications, justification for recruitment of additional firefighters, and future

impacts to the hiring process. Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer, Kassandra Cruciano, Grants, Partnerships and Strategic Initiatives Coordinator, and Mary Lou Cosentino, Manager of Human Resource Services, responded to questions from Council Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That By-law numbers 01-2022 to 03-2022 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

Members requested that the question be divided and that by-law 03-2022 be voted on separately.

Motion 1

That By-law numbers 01-2022 and 02-2022 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

Motion 2

That By-law number 03-2022 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

MOTION LOST

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Regional Councillor Lee, Mayor Collier

Opposed: Councillor Tyler Morin, Councillor Bower, Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Khan

Motion

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: L. Bower

That By-law number 05-2022 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

11. Notice of Motion

There were no notices of motion.

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming events and activities including a community Ward 1 meeting on January 25, 2022, a community Ward 2 meeting on February 22, 2022, and Annual Durham Black History Month Celebration on February 5, 2022.

Council Members asked if the Automated Speed Enforcement cameras are operational. Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, noted that one camera is operating in test mode and installation of the other two cameras has been delayed to due to supply issues.

13. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That By-law number 04-2022 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its meeting held on January 24, 2022 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

14. Adjournment

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the January 24, 2022 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (8:57 p.m.)

CARRIED

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Mayor

_____
D-Clerk